

Budget vs Actual Sales Analysis Dashboard (FY2018)

1. Business Problem

Management needs an effective method to evaluate whether the sales target (Budget Sales) has already been achieved for every sub-category product during FY 2018.

Without a comparison between the budget and actual sales, the company will find it difficult to:

- Measure the achievement of sales targets.
- Identify subcategories that are performing well or poorly.
- Determine areas that require further attention.
- Support data-driven decision-making

Therefore, the Budget vs Actual Analysis dashboard was developed to monitor the achievement of sales targets for each quarter and subcategory.

2. Dataset Overview

Data Source

Sample Superstore Dataset (Sales Transaction Data)

Analysis Period

FY2018 (2018-Q1 to 2018-Q4)

Main Attributes Used

Category	Fields
Time Dimension	Order Date, Quarter
Product Dimension	Sub Category
Sales Metrics	Sales (Actual Sales)
Budget Metrics	Budget Sales

Data Preparation

The data was cleaned and processed using Microsoft Excel to:

- Make sure the data format is consistent.
- Group transactions by Quarter.
- Calculate Actual Sales by Sub Category.
- Prepare Budget Sales for each Quarter and Sub Category.

3. Budget Planning Methodology

Since the dataset does not provide information on the company's sales targets, Budget Sales was created as a simulation of business targets for analytical purposes.

Approach

1. Actual Sales are calculated based on sales transactions.
2. Budget Sales are determined for each Sub Category and Quarter.
3. Budget Sales are stored on the Budget Master sheet.
4. The dashboard compares Budget Sales with Actual Sales to generate a Variance Analysis.

Key Metrics

1. Actual Sales

The actual sales figures.

2. Budget Sales

Sales targets that are set for each Sub Category and Quarter.

3. Variance

Variance = Actual Sales – Budget Sales

4. Variance %

Variance % = (Actual Sales – Budget Sales) / Budget Sales

4. Dashboard Overview

The dashboard was developed using Microsoft Excel and consists of several main components.

KPI Cards

- Total Budget Sales
- Total Actual Sales
- Total Variance
- Variance %

Budget vs Actual Analysis

A visual comparison of Budgeted Sales and Actual Sales for each subcategory.

Variance Analysis

Displays the difference between Actual Sales and Budgeted Sales.

Top Positive Variance

Featuring the top-performing Sub Category that surpassed the target.

Top Negative Variance

Displaying subcategories that have not yet met their targets.

The dashboard is designed to enable management to quickly identify areas that require attention and opportunities for performance improvement.

5. Key Findings

Based on the FY2018 analysis:

- Several subcategories exceeded their sales targets.
- Some subcategories showed a negative variance and require further evaluation.
- Sales performance was inconsistent across subcategories.
- Variance analysis helps identify the areas that contributed most to both the achievement and failure of targets.

Dashboards allow users to monitor sales performance more quickly than traditional tabular reports.

6. Recommendations

Based on the analysis results, here are the following recommendations:

For Sub Category with Positive Variance

- Maintain the current sales strategy.
- Analyze the success factors to replicate them in other subcategories.
- Consider increasing sales targets for the next period.

For Sub Category with Negative Variance

- Evaluate the reasons for failing to meet targets.
- Review marketing and sales strategies.
- Conduct regular monitoring of sales performance.

For Management

- Use dashboards as a tool for routine monitoring.
- Implement data-driven decision-making in the sales target planning process.

7. Conclusion

This project successfully developed a **Budget vs. Actual Analysis Dashboard** using Microsoft Excel to monitor the achievement of sales targets during FY2018.

Through this dashboard, users can:

- Compare Budget Sales and Actual sales.
- Measure Variance and Variance Percentages.
- Identify the best- and worst-performing Sub Category.
- Support data-driven decision-making.

This project demonstrated skills in:

- Data Analysis
- Business Reporting
- Budget vs Actual Analysis
- Dashboard Development
- Microsoft Excel (Pivot Table, SUMIFS, XLOOKUP, Conditional Formatting, Charts)